

BALAAJEE VR

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Chennai, India

LinkedIn Profile

PORTFOLIO & WORKS

Design Gallery (Behance)

EDUCATION

B.E. Information Technology
MS University • 2004

TEACHING & PRACTICE AREAS

HCI & DESIGN ENGINEERING

- Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- Enterprise Design Systems & Tokens
- AI-UX Systems (Watson & GenAI)
- Design Thinking & Usability Engineering
- Front-End Engineering Handoff

PEDAGOGY & MENTORSHIP

- Industry Capstone Project Guidance
- Studio Sprints & Agile Methodologies
- Design Critiques & Portfolio Reviews
- Global Hackathons & Contests

INSTITUTIONAL SYNERGY

- Industry MoUs (IBM, Ericsson, Zebra)
- Student Placements & Internships
- Incubation & Corporate R&D Mentorship

TECHNOLOGY & AI STACK

AI & Automation: IBM Watson, MS Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, Google Stitch, AI Studio, NotebookLM

HCI & Design: Figma, Miro, Mural, Design Tokens, FigJam

Engineering & Agile: Jira, Git, Confluence, Monday.com, UserTesting, Hotjar

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Samsung: 10-Year US Business Visa for driving global healthcare UX research.

Ericsson: Spot Award for sustaining UX innovation culture.

Ericsson: 1st Place, Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest.

Product Impact: Designed "Greedy Jump" iOS app (80K+ downloads).

Design Contests: 1st Place in MockingBOT & UP Labs UX Challenges.

PRODUCT DESIGN EXECUTIVE

18+ Years

HCI • Enterprise Design Systems • Software Engineering

50+	5	1.5 Yrs
MENTORED	TECH GIANTS	TEACHING

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL STATEMENT

Distinguished Technology and Product Design Leader with 18+ years of enterprise experience across IBM, Zebra Technologies, Ericsson, Samsung, and Infosys, backed by a foundational B.E. in Information Technology (MS University) and prior Anna University affiliated engineering college teaching experience. Uniquely positioned to bridge V-SIGN (School of Design) and SCOPE (School of Computer Science & Engineering) by synthesizing Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), enterprise design systems, and generative AI with production software engineering. Seeking to serve as Professor of Practice at VIT Chennai to mentor students through studio-based learning, industry-sponsored capstones, curriculum modernization, and high-impact placement readiness.

INDUSTRY PRACTICE & TECHNOLOGY LEADERSHIP

UI/UX Design — Senior Manager
Sep 2024 – Jan 2026
IBM Software Labs

- Transitioned 12 designers into a centralized UX-as-a-Service studio model, fostering cross-functional design-engineering collaboration across global software portfolios.
- Mentored and upskilled multidisciplinary teams in adopting AI tools (Watson, GenAI) into day-to-day operations, establishing modern AI-assisted prototyping and interaction workflows.
- Architected AI-UX interaction models for IBM Watson in Rhapsody SE (system modeling) and MaaS360 (endpoint management), simplifying complex engineering protocols into intuitive user interfaces.
- Standardized UX governance and heuristics across software labs, mitigating deployment risks in mission-critical enterprise environments.

UI/UX Product Design Manager
Jul 2021 – Aug 2024
Zebra Technologies

- Directed a multi-disciplinary UI/UX team across B2B hardware and enterprise software portfolios; served as primary Hiring & Mentorship Manager, developing talent from entry to senior levels.
- Facilitated studio-based Lean UX workshops and Agile/PI planning sessions, bridging engineering constraints with user-centered product strategy.
- Standardized enterprise design system tokens and component libraries, accelerating engineering handoffs and ensuring visual consistency across squads.

UI/UX Senior Specialist
Oct 2020 – Jul 2021
ZF Wabco

- Spearheaded UX strategy for mission-critical automotive infotainment and telematics software, applying cognitive ergonomics and user research to driver safety interfaces.
- Scaled enterprise UI component libraries and coached junior designers in data-informed design methodologies.

UI/UX Designer
Jul 2019 – Sep 2020
Ericsson Global

- Won 1st Place in Ericsson Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest and earned Spot Award for sustaining collaborative innovation culture.
- Architected and standardized the Ericsson Design System, establishing consistent UI components across global development centers.

Lead UI/UX Designer
Sep 2017 – Jul 2019
NP Compete Technologies

- Directed end-to-end design cycles, managing sprint backlogs and mentoring junior designers in rapid prototyping and user research.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Creative Head** — Titi Technologies — May 2010 – Apr 2015
- **Senior Software Engineer** — Infosys Technologies — Jan 2006 – Apr 2010
- **Lecturer (IT)** — SKR Engg. College (Anna Univ. Affiliated) — May 2005 – Jan 2006
- **Teaching Faculty** — Computer Science & IT Department — Aug 2004 – Mar 2005